

Financial Counselling Service - Arc@UNSW

Intake & Privacy, Confidentiality and Consent Form

Personal Details

Full Name: _____ Anirban Chakrabarty _____

Date of Birth: __20__ / __11__ / __1976__.

Gender: ☐ Female ☒ Male ☐ Other _____ Male _____

Address: _____ 8/71 Wolseley Street, Bexley _____.

Postcode: _____ 2207 _____.

Phone: _____ +61 470 142229 _____

Marital Status: ☐ Single; ☒ Married; ☐ De Facto; ☐ Divorced; ☐ Other
_____ Married _____

Identity:

☐ Aboriginal

☐ Torres Strait Islander

☐ Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander

☒ Other (please specify): _____ Indian/ South Asian _____

Language spoken at home (other than English): __Bengali, Hindi_____

Main source of income:

☒ part-time; ☐ full-time; ☐ Centrelink; ☐ Family; ☐ Scholarship or

other: _____ PartTime _____.

Highest level of education: _____ Masters (MBA) _____.

Course you are currently enrolled in: __Masters in Data Science Online_____

Course number:(____8646____)

Type of housing: ☐ rent shared housing ☒ rent Unit/house ☐ family ☐ own
property

What is Financial Counselling?

Financial counselling is a **free, confidential, and independent service** that helps people experiencing financial difficulty.

At Arc@UNSW, our Financial Counsellor will:

- **May advocate for you** with creditors, landlords, utility companies, or other service providers.
- Support you in **understanding your financial rights and responsibilities**.
- Help you create **budgets and financial plans** that work for your situation.
- Explore **options to manage or reduce debts and bills**.
- Connect you with **legal, health, housing, or community services** when needed.
- Provide **information about scholarships, grants, and student financial supports other entitlement**.

Our role is to **stand beside you, represent your interests, and guide you** so you feel more confident and supported in managing your finances. We always act under a **duty of care** and in the **best interest of the client**.

Privacy, Confidentiality & Duty of Care

Arc@UNSW Financial Counselling complies with the **Privacy Act 1988 (Cth)**, the **Australian Privacy Principles**, and the **Health Records and Information Privacy Act 2002 (NSW)**.

Your information will be treated as **private and confidential**. However, there are some **legal and ethical exceptions** where confidentiality must be broken:

- If required by a court, tribunal, or law enforcement authority.
- If there is a **serious and imminent risk** of harm to yourself or others (for example, threats of self-harm or harm to another person).
- If required by law (e.g., child protection legislation).

In these situations, we act under a **duty of care** to protect your safety and wellbeing, while still working in your **best interest**.

Access to Your File

- You have the right to request access to your personal records (in writing).
- Only authorised Arc@UNSW staff may access your file.
- Files are stored securely (locked or password-protected).

Consent to Share Information

☐ I consent to Arc@UNSW collecting and disclosing my personal information only to the third parties I nominate below.

☐ I do not consent to Arc@UNSW disclosing my personal information to any third parties.

Nominated Third Parties (optional):

_____.

Understanding of Rights and Assessment Process

☒ Confidentiality

☒ Privacy

☒ Disclosure (limitations to confidentiality)

☒ Duty of care

☒ Consent to exchange information with referral agencies (if required)

Expectations of Arc@UNSW Services

What do you expect from this service?

I am seeking independent financial counselling, hardship guidance, and support in understanding my options while an unresolved university administrative and FEE-HELP matter is under formal review.

I would like assistance understanding what protections, hardship pathways, temporary relief options, or advocacy supports may exist in circumstances where a student is facing serious financial stress arising from a disputed tuition fee issue.

I am also seeking guidance on how to manage the immediate impact of account holds, uncertainty around my graduation, and the financial risks this situation poses to my family and household stability.

Overview of Current Situation — What brings you in?

I am currently experiencing significant financial stress and emotional distress arising from an unresolved administrative issue at UNSW relating to my FEE-HELP status following my progression from the Graduate Diploma in Data Science into the Master of Data Science program.

Historically, my tuition fees throughout my studies at UNSW had always been supported through Commonwealth FEE-HELP as an Australian citizen, and I had never previously encountered a requirement to manually re-confirm or reapply for FEE-HELP during internal academic progression.

Following my transfer into the Master of Data Science program, UNSW changed my fee liability status to “Domestic Fee Paying” and sent an email requiring me to reconfirm or apply for FEE-HELP before the census date.

At the time, I did not understand the practical meaning or financial implications of the “Domestic Fee Paying” status, nor did I understand that failure to complete the process would result in personal tuition fee liability. I did not understand that I was effectively transitioning out of Commonwealth-supported arrangements, and I do not believe I knowingly accepted personal fee liability for the affected teaching periods.

Recognising that I was uncertain, I proactively sought assistance from my Student Success Advisor and forwarded the official university email before the census deadline seeking guidance and clarification.

Based on my communications and support sessions, my understanding was that the matter would be taken care of and that I did not need to worry. I relied on the university support guidance provided to me in good faith when deciding not to take further action myself.

Over the following weeks and months, I repeatedly raised concerns because my myUNSW portal access remained restricted, including access to enrolment and academic systems. I was repeatedly assured that the issue would be taken care of.

I was later informed that my FEE-HELP had not been processed for the transferred program and that my account now reflected approximately \$10,110 in disputed tuition liability along with administrative holds and denial of services.

I am now facing uncertainty regarding my academic progression, graduation, and future PhD pathway.

This situation has caused substantial stress and instability for me and my family.

Presenting Issues or debts:

- Disputed UNSW tuition fee liability following unresolved FEE-HELP administrative issue
- Overdue account and Denial of Services holds on myUNSW account
- Restricted access to academic records, enrolment systems, and university services
- Significant financial hardship and uncertainty
- Inability to realistically pay the disputed amount upfront
- Family financial pressure while supporting a child and household expenses on part-time income
- Emotional distress, anxiety, and uncertainty regarding graduation and future academic plans
- Concern regarding possible long-term financial and academic consequences while the matter remains unresolved

If we had to prioritise, what specific issue would you like to discuss first?

The most urgent issue I would like to discuss first is the immediate financial hardship and risk created by the unresolved tuition fee liability and associated university holds.

I would like guidance on what financial hardship protections, temporary relief options, or practical support pathways may exist while the underlying FEE-HELP and administrative fairness issues are being formally reviewed.

I am particularly concerned about the impact this situation may have on my ability to support my family, maintain housing and essential living costs, and complete my degree and future PhD pathway without severe financial disruption.

Acknowledgement

I, Anirban Chakrabarty, have read and understood the above information. I understand my rights to privacy, confidentiality, advocacy, duty of care, and access to my records, and that I may withdraw my consent at any time.

Name of Student: Anirban Chakrabarty

Signature: Anirban Chakrabarty

Date: 12/ 5/ 2026